beyond which lies the kitchen, pantry and an area for animals. Vessels that store grain or oil are sunk into the pantry floor.



Figure 6. Pillar with scenes of social life

Stepping inside many homes, we're struck by the profusion of pottery items: dishes with or without lids, bowls, cups, wine jars, pots in lota and other styles, water vessels, storage jars, finials and lamps. Most of these are utilitarian in design but a few are more 'deluxe', with fancy spouts, handles and shaped like bulls or cats. Usually painted, many have fine decorations with floral and geometric designs, as well as animals and human figures, including dancers and musicians. Here and there we even find the occasional luxury of a glazed amphora.

Back along the city streets, we walk past shops and ateliers, where goldsmiths, ivory and shell artists, and glass-bangle makers ply their crafts. Shoppers haggle over piles of beads fashioned from coral, crystal, pearl, jasper and glass, as well as a range of mass-produced yet high-quality